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[00:15:51] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:16:09] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Pastor Michael Keyes, New Hope Baptist Church, Virginia Beach, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Heron. Good morning. Let us pray. Eternal and most sovereign God, we have gathered in this chamber today, keenly aware that history is watching and generations yet unborn will feel the weight of what is decided in this place. We give thanks for the privilege, God, to serve. We do not take lightly or for granted the authority entrusted to this assembly by the people of this great

[00:16:46] commonwealth. In a time, oh God, marked by division, uncertainty, and competing voices, grant our leaders wisdom that rises above mere politics, courage that does not bend under pressure and integrity that refuses compromise with injustice sharpen discernment oh God so truth is not obscured and strengthen resolve so decisions are guided by conscious and not convenience ignite within this body a spirit committed to fairness and the common good of all people give righteous clarity to confront policies and practices that oppress exclude or

[00:17:22] diminish human dignity let debate be honest governance be responsible and service be rooted in compassion. May this assembly govern with vision, act with humility, and lead with moral clarity, so that the work done here strengthens communities, protects the vulnerable, and leaves this Commonwealth better for those that will follow us. We offer this prayer in reverence and hope, trusting that wisdom greater than our own continues to guide us in all. In the name of the one who is from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

[00:17:53] The clerk will report the result of the special election that occurred in the 17th House of Delegates District.

[00:18:45] Mr. Speaker, members, please be advised to pursue into Article 4, Section 7 of the Virginia Constitution, providing that the House of Delegates, quote, shall judge of the election, qualification, and returns of its members, unquote, and in the direction of the Speaker. I am pleased to report the following. In the special election called by the Speaker to fill the vacancy in the 17th House District, which occurred on Tuesday, January 20th, 2026, it has been determined that Garrett Z. McGuire received a majority of the votes cast and was duly sworn in

[00:19:17] earlier today. And Mr. Speaker, further communi- sorry, you want to go ahead. Your turn. The members

[00:19:44] will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board. Clerk will We'll close the roll.

[00:19:59] Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Assuming to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the General House of Delegates for January 20th, 2026. Motions and resolutions under Rule 39, pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40, are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:20:14] Yes, sir. Now, Mr. Speaker, a letter from him to the clerk have made the following committee assignments effective today. For Delegate McGuire, appointed to the Committee on County, Cities, and Towns, Committee on Health and Human Services, and the Committee on Communications, Technology, and Innovation.

[00:20:31] Sincerely, Don Scott, Speaker of the House. Now, in this first portion of the morning, our speaker requests that you use a request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Fagans. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction.

[00:20:48] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, in the House today, we have Pastor Michael Keyes of New Hope Baptist Church. He's already standing. Located in House District 97 in Virginia Beach, who offered our opening prayer. Pastor Keyes is a devoted husband, father, veteran, and community leader with more than 20 years of service in the United States Navy and over 27 years in leadership in the private sector.

[00:21:12] He answered his call to ministry at New Hope Baptist Church and was ordained in 2019 and in July 2023 was installed as only the second pastor in the church's 55-year history. He owes degrees from St. Leo University and Virginia Union University, and is currently pursuing his doctorate in ministry.

[00:21:34] On a personal note, I want to thank Pastor Keyes and First Lady for their guidance and prayers during some of the most difficult moments in my life. Members, we thank Pastor Keyes for his prayers, his

service to this nation, and his steadfast commitment to our community, and I would ask the House to give him a warm House welcome.

[00:21:51] Welcome, Pastor Keyes. Welcome to the Capitol.

[00:22:07] The Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Don't ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. With us today, we have the Virginia 4-H Livestock and the Virginia 4-H Horse Ambassadors, cohorts and their mentors from the Virginia Cooperative Extension Service.

[00:22:26] Selected for their knowledge of their respective industries and initiatives as leaders, the 4-H Youth Livestock and Horse Ambassadors Program strives to develop skills in leadership, public speaking, citizenship, and professionalism. Ambassadors serve in a variety of 4-H outreach and service roles in events throughout the Commonwealth during their year-long ambassador's term.

[00:22:50] They are asked to be a positive role model and serve others and advocate for the livestock and horse industries. They are encouraged to make positive contributions and impacts not only on the regional and state level, but especially in their local communities by identifying local 4-H needs and developing and delivering programs to meet those needs while strengthening the interest of 4-H youth in livestock and horse programs.

[00:23:17] Collectively, the Horse and Livestock Ambassadors represent 17 counties and cities in the Commonwealth. Please join me in giving this group a warm house welcome.

[00:23:38] - Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an announcement. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Just wanted to share a quick announcement that our first Technology and Innovation Caucus meeting will happen on Thursday, January 22nd at 4 p.m.

[00:24:00] in House 8th Floor, Room 800. Just so folks know, some of the new folks, this is an education caucus. It's not tied to a committee. It is simply formed to help us learn more about AI and new and emerging technologies. We'll be talking specifically about the AI executive order and its impact on state legislative efforts and also multi-state responses and 2026 legislative highlights.

[00:24:25] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, I also rise for the purpose of a motion to adopt a resolution. The clerk shall report House Joint Resolution 74.

[00:24:41] House Joint Resolution No. 74, election of circuit court judges, general district court judges, juvenile and domestic relations district court judges, a member of the state corporation, Commission, and a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission. Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of the resolution.

[00:24:58] Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:25:15] Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The resolution is agreed to. The Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Leftwich. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise today to welcome a group of distinguished visitors to the Capitol.

[00:25:31] Joining us here today are members of the Hampton Roads Realtors Association. If they're in the gallery, I ask them to please stand. These folks have traveled across Hampton Roads region to be here with us today during this legislative session. These realtors are not only professionals who help Virginians

achieve the dream of homeownership, but they also are deeply engaged in their civic leaders and advocates for their communities.

[00:25:55] Their work supports local economies, strengthens neighborhoods, and helps us ensure that housing opportunities remain accessible for families throughout the Commonwealth. Today, they're here to share their perspective on issues affecting property rights, housing affordability, and the vitality of our local communities and to learn more about the work we do on behalf of Virginia here in the General Assembly. We're grateful for their involvement in the legislative process and for them taking the time to engage with us at the Capitol. Mr. Speaker, as a private practicing attorney for almost 37 years dealing in real estate, I can tell you that

[00:26:32] they're invaluable to the American dream of owning a home. And I ask the members to give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Doherty.

[00:26:56] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Visiting today in the gallery, we have distinguished guests joining us from the City of Hopewell. Will the delegation please stand? The City of Hopewell is an amazing place to live, work, and play and has a vibrant history.

[00:27:18] I invite everyone to visit some of the wonderful attractions like the historic Beacon Theater in downtown Hopewell. It's a wonderful venue to catch a show or a concert. A short walk away is the Hopewell Riverwalk that's a boardwalk along the Appomattox River at City Point, which is a perfect place for scenic views, nature watching, and fishing.

[00:27:38] After all of these wonderful exercise opportunities, I welcome folks to step into this Wave sandwich shop, Tropic Island Grill, or the Boathouse for a delicious bite to eat. Mr. Speaker and fellow delegates, please join me in giving a warm house welcome to our guests from the city of Hopewell.

[00:28:00] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Richmond County, Delegate Kent. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate, as the floor. Thank you. Virginia is home to many wonderful industries and commodities, and one of the very best, in my opinion, is the seafood industry.

[00:28:22] Today, we welcome and offer our sincere thanks, not just for the delicious lunch, but also for the value and hard work of our watermen. To the Virginia Watermen's Association and the Virginia Marine Products Board, thank you. The Virginia seafood industry produces more than $1 billion boosts to our Virginia's economy.

[00:28:42] It supports more than 7,000 jobs. And we are a national leader in oyster production and aquaculture. Thank you. I would ask that the House give them a warm welcome, even though they're still outside probably working, for this special day in the seafood industry.

[00:28:58] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Smith. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:29:16] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Today, we welcome members of the Virginia Association for Personal Care Providers, if they would please stand. Thank you. The Virginia Association for Personal Care Providers, also known as the VAPCP, is a statewide

organization of agency-directed personal care providers advocating for the elderly and the disabled individuals.

[00:29:42] VAPCP employs hundreds of thousands of caregivers to assist vulnerable Virginians receiving community-based care instead of institutionalized care. The VAPCP agency-based personal care providers are effective stakeholders supporting elderly and disabled individuals to remain safely and age in their community.

[00:30:03] If you all will please join me, I would give them a warm house welcome to the VAPCP. Delegate from Rockbridge, Delegate McLaughlin.

[00:30:22] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We've already heard that we have some 4-H students here today, but I'm really pleased to have our Rockbridge County 4-H students here. Thank you for standing. Mr. Speaker, these students come here to learn about agriculture, the different things that we need and the different things that they can advocate for.

[00:30:43] Every year I get to meet with them and I see them throughout my community. I get more impressed every year with their passion and their advocacy. I can tell you that agriculture is in good hands with the future. So if everyone would please join me in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:31:10] The delegate from Dinwiddie, Delegate Pope Adams. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned in the honor and memory of Dr. Gladys B. West.

[00:31:29] And I'd like to speak to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you again, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, on Sunday, the Commonwealth and, in fact, the world lost a true pioneer. Born Gladys May Brown on a tobacco farm in Dinwiddie County, Dr. West learned the value of hard work at an early age.

[00:31:47] Her mother often told her, you can do anything, but you have to get an education. And Dr. West did just that. She graduated as her high school valedictorian and earned a scholarship to what is now the Virginia State University.

[00:32:04] After completing both undergraduate and graduate studies in mathematics, she accepted a position at the Naval Surface Warfare Center in Dahlgren, becoming only the fourth black person ever hired there. The man who would become her husband was the third.

[00:32:21] Mr. Speaker, her brilliance was undeniable. Her ability to solve complex equations by hand and to program computers helped earn her the opportunity to work on Project Geosat, laying critical groundwork for what we now know as the Global Positioning System, or GPS.

[00:32:41] Even after retirement, Gladys never stopped learning. She went on to earn her Ph.D. from Virginia Tech, thus becoming Dr. Gladys B. West, a proud Dinwiddie native and one of Virginia's hidden figures whose work continues to guide our path every single day.

[00:32:59] So, Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned in the honor and memory of our Dinwiddie-born pioneer, Trojan, Hokie, and trailblazer, Dr. Gladys B. West. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:33:14] The delegate from Petersburg moves that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned in the honoring memory of Dr. Gladys B. West.

[00:33:34] Those in favor shall please rise. The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Bedford, Delegate Griffin. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:33:49] Today I rise to recognize the homeschoolers of Virginia United against overreach, if they could please stand. This is a grassroots coalition founded in 2024 by Elena, who's with us up there. this organization was created to ensure that parents remain the primary decision makers in their children's education and defend the rights of Virginia's vibrant and growing homeschool community. Homeschoolers of Virginia United Against Overreach brings together families, advocates, and community leaders who are committed to protecting parental authority, promoting educational freedom, and supporting homeschooling as a meaningful and effective option for families across the Commonwealth of Virginia. Their members work tirelessly to

[00:34:28] uplift the voices of parents to ensure their rights are respected and to safeguard the flexibility that has made homeschooling a successful pathway for so many of our students here in Virginia. I ask my colleagues to please join me in giving them a warm welcome in the Capitol today. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery we have members of the Chesapeake Public School Board and the

[00:35:07] Superintendent. If they could please rise. Awesome. Chesapeake School Board and public school serves over 40,000 students at its 45 schools, two centers, and a virtual academy program. The school's mission is to promote educational excellence by engaging all students in meaningful and innovative learning to empower them to successfully fulfill their life's purpose.

[00:35:31] The school board is dedicated to the advancement of public education, ensuring that all students have the tools and resources they need to reach their full potential. I just want to thank them for being here and their work that they do to inspire all their students. I hope it will be the will of the body to give them a warm House welcome.

[00:35:52] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Powhatan. Delegate Ware. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. Delegate, the floor.

[00:36:08] Thank you. I move that House Resolution 21 on page 14 be called up out of order so that we may vote on this resolution commending First Baptist Church of Midlothian. There are reasons of timeliness for this motion.

[00:36:24] Without objection. Mr. Speaker, House Resolution No. 21 commanding the First Baptist Church of Midlothian is now before the body. All those in favor of adopting House Resolution No. 21, please say aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:36:40] House Resolution No. 21 is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker and members. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delgott Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I ask that House Resolution 23 be called up out of order, and I move for the adoption of this resolution.

[00:37:01] Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution No. 23, commending Chesapeake Regional Health Care, excuse me, HR 23 is now before the body. All those in favor of adopting House Resolution No. 23 shall say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Delegate from Sussex, Delegate Waxman.

[00:37:20] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the delegate from Albemarle and the delegate from Middlesex joined me today to meet with the Virginia Pharmacists Association members, as well as the Virginia Society of Health System Pharmacists. They really filled the room up there, Mr. Speaker.

[00:37:41] Today we have a smaller group here that are representing the pharmacists from all across Virginia. They're here today lobbying and meeting with their legislators to lobby for just the things that they need to help take care of their patients, if they could please rise, please. But they're here to advocate to providing professional care to patients all across Virginia, and it is my favor to present them today and introduce them, and I do ask that the house, give them a warm house. Welcome. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:38:20] The delegate from Virginia Beach, delegate, ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of two introductions. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, visiting us today in the Capitol are the members of the Virginia Fire Chiefs Association. If they're in the gallery, can they please rise? Mr. Speaker, the Virginia Fire Chiefs Association is a nonpartisan organization that was formed in 1930 with a mission to serve Virginia's communities by advancing fire and rescue services through leadership, education, and advocacy.

[00:38:47] Today, they're visiting the General Assembly for the third annual lobby day to advocate for sustainable funding for your local fire departments to ensure high-quality emergency response for every resident and visitor across every region of our great Commonwealth, and for that, we are very grateful. Mr. Speaker, I ask that the body join us in giving them a warm house welcome.

[00:39:18] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol, and thank you for all that you do. The delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian. Mr. Speaker. Oh, you had two introductions. Yes, if you allow, Ms. Speaker. Show off. I'm with a show off in the crowd. If you allow. Delegate from Virginia Beach. Delegate, ask you. Thank you, Ms. Speaker. Ms. Speaker, in the gallery today, we have presidents from our HBCUs and their representatives, if they could please rise.

[00:39:38] Ms. Speaker, earlier today, I joined members of this body to announce the launch of an HBCU caucus. As a proud HBCU alum of Hampton University, I'm honored to serve as co-chair of this caucus. The Virginia HBCU caucus is a bicarbonate legislative caucus dedicated to promoting and protecting the interests of Virginia's historically black colleges and universities.

[00:39:56] The caucus will advance policies that strengthen institutional sustainability, expand student access and affordability, and support workforce development, social and economic mobility across the Commonwealth. Virginia is home to five HBCUs, three private and two public, that educate, employ, and uplift communities throughout the state.

[00:40:14] The institutions provide critical pathways to higher education for students who may not otherwise have access, while producing a significant share of the Commonwealth's educators, healthcare professionals, public servants, and business leaders. Despite these undeniable contributions, many

HBCUs continue to face infrastructure and affordability challenges that require deliberate and focused legislative attention.

[00:40:35] In the gallery today are presidents from our HBCUs, General Delia Williams, president of Hampton University, Dr. Makola Abdullah, president of Virginia State University, unable to be here, but president of Virginia University of Lynchburg, Dr. Kathy Franklin, Dr. Hakeem Lucas, president of Virginia University, University, and last but definitely not least, Dr. J, or formerly known as Dr. Javon Adams-Gaston, president of Norfolk State University.

[00:41:01] I'd ask that we give them a warm house welcome.

[00:41:14] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol. For those that are keeping score at home, that's three alphas and one delta up there. The delegate from Prince William, delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'll rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, it's my pleasure to welcome back to this house a gentleman who spent 22 years in this chamber, 18 of those years on the Committee of Appropriations, and six of those 22 years as chair of the Committee on Appropriations. House members, please join me in welcoming

[00:41:48] back to this house former Delegate Chris Jones. Welcome back, Delegate Jones. I mean, I'm sorry, Chairman Jones. I apologize. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of one introduction. The Delegate has the floor, Slacker. Mr. Speaker, we're We're joined in the gallery today by members of the Virginia Land Title Association.

[00:42:26] If they please rise so that we can recognize them. Mr. Speaker, the Virginia Land Title Association is in the capital today for their annual lobby day. For more than 50 years, VTLA has been a trusted voice for Virginia's land title industry, promoting professionalism, integrity, and ongoing education throughout the Commonwealth.

[00:42:43] Every day, Virginia Land Title Association members help ensure that real estate transactions move forward smoothly and securely, giving homebuyers and property owners confidence in supporting a strong housing market and economy. I especially appreciate their commitment to working constructively with policy makers and in upholding their members to the highest standards of professional service.

[00:43:03] On behalf of my colleagues, I would like to thank the VLTA for being here today. I hope it would be the pleasure of the House to give them a very warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:43:21] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction and an announcement. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker and members, joining us in the gallery today are volunteers from AARP Virginia.

[00:43:38] If you could please rise. They are here in Richmond this week advocating for policies that make life better for Virginians over 50 and their families, including prescription drug affordability, paid family leave, protection from crypto kiosk fraud, and better staffing in nursing homes.

[00:43:56] AARP is the nation's largest nonprofit, nonpartisan organization dedicated to empowering people 50 and older to choose how they live as they age. With a nationwide presence and nearly 38 million members, including over 1 million here in the Commonwealth, AARP strengthens communities and

advocates for what matters most to families, health security, financial stability, and personal fulfillment. I hope it is the will of this body to give them a warm house welcome. Welcome, welcome

[00:44:36] to the Capitol. Although I don't look it, I am a member. The delegate from Richmond City, delegate Mr. Speaker. Oh, you had to show off. That's right. Now you have an announcement. For an announcement. Mr. Speaker and members, I'm happy to announce that during the 2026 session, the Aerospace and Aviation Caucus will meet each Thursday from 8 a.m. to 9 a.m. in the GAB Subcommittee Room 600B. So please join us to be part of this meeting as your schedule allows.

[00:45:03] As you know, the aviation and aerospace industry is an important sector in the Commonwealth and all are welcome to attend. Thank you. Sergeant in Arms. Mr. Speaker, a message from the Senate. The Senator from Fairfax, Senator Surveille, Leader Surveille. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:45:22] Surveille. Just don't call me late for dinner. Mr. Speaker, I have been directed by the President of the Senate to inform the House of Delegates. The Senate has agreed to house join Resolution 74. We're now ready to reelect some judges. Thank you. The Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr.

[00:45:38] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us today in the gallery are members of the Virginia Association of recovery residences and real life they're here today for recovery advocacy day I would ask them to please stand bar is a statewide network of certified recovery residents operators from across the Commonwealth bars purpose is to support strengthen and uphold high-quality recovery housing that provides safe stable and standards based environments for individuals in

[00:46:17] recovery from substance use disorders. VAR residences are committed to accountability, transparency, and evidence-informed best practices aligned with national standards. What matters most to them is preserving access to recovery housing, maintaining clear and workable standards, and partnering with the Commonwealth to strengthen this essential component of Virginia's recovery continuum. I ask my colleagues please to please join me in giving the

[00:46:45] members of the Virginia Association of Recovery Residents. A warm house welcome today. Welcome.

[00:47:01] Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. And today in the gallery, we are joined by Shineforth, if they could please stand. Shineforth, formerly the United Methodist Family Services, and prior to that, formerly the United Methodist Children's Home, which was the name that It went by when I was placed there in 1972 and was still very much an orphanage.

[00:47:31] Shineforth and all of those previous iterations have been serving the children and families of the Commonwealth for more than 125 years. Since their founding as a Methodist orphanage in 1900, they have been adapting and evolving to meet the changing needs of children and family. Today, they serve communities across Virginia from eight locations, including their main campus in Richmond and locations in Annandale, Edinburgh, Farmville, Fredericksburg, Lynchburg, South Hill, and Tidewater.

[00:47:59] The new Shine Forth brand positions the organization for the next 125 years by bringing forth the light and opportunity of every child in need, much as it did for me so many years ago. At Shine Forth, their mission continues to be unwavering champions for children and families.

[00:48:15] I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to be able to give them a warm House welcome.

[00:48:28] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Pursuant to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business. I'm going to grant a lead from today's section. Delegates Carroll and Knight. Clerk will announce the next order of business.

[00:48:44] Mr. Speaker, based upon today's calendar, the second and the third portion of the morning hour are not applicable. Clerk will call the next order. Therefore, the fourth and final portion of the morning hour reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege. Speaker kindly asks you to use the request speak button to get into the queue. The time for the joint order has arrived, and the House, on its part, is ready to proceed with the execution of House Joint Resolution 74.

[00:49:12] Nominations are now in order for Judges of Judicial Circuit. The clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution No. 24, nominating persons to be elected to Circuit Court Judgeships, which that resolution is now before you. Are there further nominations?

[00:49:28] The chair hears none. As many as favor the adoption of the resolution will say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for judges of the general district courts. The clerk will report a resolution. House resolution number 25, nominating persons to be elected to general district court judgeships.

[00:49:46] H.R. 25 is before you. Are there further nominations? The chair hears none. As many as favor the adoption of the resolution will say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for judges of the juvenile and domestic relations court.

[00:50:03] The clerk will report a resolution. House resolution number 26, nominating persons to be elected to juvenile and domestic relations District Court judgeships. H.R. 26 is before you. Are there further nominations? The chair hears none. As many as favor the adoption of the resolution will say aye. Those opposed, no. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for a member of the State Corporation Commission. Clerk will report a resolution. House resolution number 27, nominating a person to be elected as a member of the State Corporation Commission. Are there further nominations? The chair hears none. As many as favor the adoption of the resolution will say aye. Those opposed,

[00:50:41] no. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission. The clerk will report a resolution. Ms. Speaker, House Resolution No. 28, nominating a person to be elected to the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission. Are there further nominations? The chair hears none. As many as favor the adoption of the resolution will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:51:03] The resolution is agreed to. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Marlonato, will inform the Senate of the nominations made by the House. The House will be at ease.

[00:55:19] House will come to order. Sergeant at Arms. Mr. Speaker, a message from the Senate.

[00:59:32] Senator, senior senator from Fairfax. Senator Surville. Not yet, just the eastern senator from eastern Fairfax. Working on that senior thing. Mr. Speaker. Freaking the Senate thinks they know everything. Go ahead. Mr. Speaker, I have been directed by the president of the Senate to inform the House of Delegates that in the execution of joint order pursuant to House Joint Resolution 74, nominations

have been made by the Senate for certain judicial offices and other offices the Commonwealth has listed in the attached papers. Thank you,

[01:00:00] senior senator from Eastern Fairfax. House will be at ease. House will come to order. Block voting

[01:02:52] for judges and other judicial officers will now commence. Those in favor of the nominees for judges of the circuit court, as noted in House Resolution 24, for terms of eight years commencing on the date specified, will vote yes. Clerk will open the row. Clerk will close the row. Those in favor of the nominees for judges of the general district courts, as noted in House Resolution 25, for terms

[01:03:30] of six years commencing on the date specified will vote yes. Clerk will close the roll. Those in favor of the nominees for judges of the juvenile and domestic relations district courts as noted in House Resolution 26 for terms of six years commencing on the date specified will vote

[01:03:57] yes. Those in favor of the nominee the clerk will close the roll. Those in favor of the nominee for a member of the state corporation commission as noted in House Resolution 27 for a term of six

[01:04:19] years commencing on February 1st, 2026 will vote yes. Clerk will close the roll. Those in favor of nominee for a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission as noted in House Resolution 28 for a term of six years commencing on February 1, 2026. We'll vote yes. The clerk will close the

[01:04:58] row. The clerk will call the calendar. House will be at ease. Hope, Maldonado, and Kilgore. The

[01:05:48] committee on the part of the House to count and report the vote of each House in each case. We'll

[01:05:52] go down to the old Senate chamber. House will come to order. The joint order under House Joint

[01:13:48] Resolution 74 will be resumed. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'm pleased to report that the committee to count the vote of each House met and the nominees fulfill the criteria for election. I move that the reading of the report be waived. The question is, shall the reading of the report be waived?

[01:14:06] This is a recorded vote. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 97, no 0.

[01:14:25] Ayes 97, no 0. The reading of the report is waived. Those judges previously nominated in House Resolution 24 having received a majority of the votes cast by members elected to each House are declared duly elected as judges of the appropriate judicial court circuits for terms of eight years commencing on the date specified.

[01:14:47] Those judges previously nominated in House Resolution 25 having received a majority of the votes cast by the members elected to each house are declared duly elected as judges of the general district courts of the appropriate judicial districts for terms of six years commencing on the date specified.

[01:15:03] Those judges previously nominated in House Resolution 26 having received a majority of the votes cast by the members elected to each house are declared duly elected as judges of the Juvenile and Domestic Relations District Courts of the appropriate judicial districts for terms of six years commencing on the date specified. Jamal T. Hudson, House of Resolution 27, having received a majority of the votes

cast by the joint vote of the two houses of the General Assembly, is declared duly elected as a member of the State Corporation Commission for a term of six years commencing on February 1st, 2026.

[01:15:37] Robert Allen Rappaport, House Resolution 28, having received the majority of the votes cast by the joint vote of the two houses of the General Assembly, is declared duly elected as a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission for a term of six years commencing on February 1, 2026.

[01:15:54] This concludes the joint order. The clerk will call the calendar. A calendar for today for the Virginia House of Delegates this Wednesday, January 21, 2026. Mr. Speaker, with the judges elected, the information on the calendar, the bills, there are information only.

[01:16:13] There is no business to come before the House today. The delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I ask that we return to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today we are joined in the gallery by James City County's 4-H.

[01:16:31] I ask that they please stand. Mr. Speaker, Virginia 4-H is the Youth Development Education Program of Virginia Cooperative Extension. 4-H is a rich with learning experiences in which young people partner with caring adults and volunteers in a fellowship unlike any other program available for youth today.

[01:16:52] Through 4-H, young people are encouraged to participate in a variety of activities that emphasize 4-H learning by doing philosophy of youth development. Standing for head, heart, hands, and health, 4-H uses more than a century of experience in youth development programming to build strong, confident leaders.

[01:17:09] Young people in the 4-H community learn leadership, citizenship, and a vast array of life skills that benefit them for the rest of their lives. The mission of 4-H is to assist youth and adults working with those youth to gain additional knowledge, life skills, and attitudes that will further their development as well as self-directing, contributing, and productive members of society.

[01:17:30] Nothing sums up what 4-H stands for better than their motto, to make the best, better. I would like the House, I'd ask the House members to give a warm House welcome to James City 4-H. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[01:17:54] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes Gamara. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'll rise for the purposes of an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, in the House today is a group of people that I admire greatly. I would ask the folks from Cornerstones to please stand.

[01:18:17] Mr. Speaker, I refer to these people as my superheroes. They are representatives of Cornerstones who, for over 55 years, have exemplified what a good neighbor looks like. They have exhibited kindness and provided resources to those who have needed housing, food, who were just short on economic times, during economic times, and they have done so graciously.

[01:18:45] And I'd also like to thank their executive leader who has been serving for over 25 years. I'd like the House to give all of them a very warm welcome and thank you for all that you have done for our community in Fairfax County and Loudoun County.

[01:19:07] Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Per House Rule 51, the House is returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements for communication? No

communication, simply announcements for the meeting scheduled for the rest of this Wednesday afternoon and looking ahead to tomorrow morning.

[01:19:26] This afternoon, a half hour upon adjournment of the House, the Appropriations Committee will be meeting up on the 12th floor in their committee room. Subsequent, there will be two of their subcommittees, the Subcommittee on Transportation and Public Safety will meet immediately upon adjournment of the Appropriations Committee and then immediately upon adjournment of the Transportation and Public Safety Subcommittee, the Subcommittee of Appropriations on Commerce, Agriculture, and Natural Resources.

[01:19:53] So two of the subs house committee room on the Appropriations Committee room on the 12th floor this afternoon. on finance will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the house they will be on the second floor house committee room B the committee for courts of justice has been counseled in lieu of their time the committee of courts of justice civil subcommittee will meet 15 minutes upon a German house they'll be on the second floor on the north subcommittee room then also the criminal sub they will immediately upon adjournment of the Finance Committee. So, of course, two subs at the times

[01:20:32] there on the second floor of the GAB. At four o'clock, Agriculture and Chesapeake and Natural Resources Agriculture Subcommittee will be meeting. They'll be in the South Subcommittee room, Subcommittee room over on the second floor. That's at four. Also at four o'clock today, Transportation Committee's Highway Safety and Policy Subcommittee, and they'll be meeting down in the lower level in house committee room a and as was mentioned previously the lgbtqia plus caucus is not meeting looking ahead to tomorrow thursday january 22nd bright and early 7 a.m the

[01:21:11] county cities and towns subcommittee number two they will be meeting in the house south subcommittee 7 a.m there the hampton roads caucus will meeting at 7 30 in the seventh floor north meeting room 7th floor north subcommittee meeting room, the public safety's subcommittee number two.

[01:21:31] They'll be meeting at 8 a.m. tomorrow. They'll be on the second floor in the north subcommittee room. Then going back slightly in time, health and human services behavioral health subcommittee at 7.30 and house committee room C. Once they're finished at 8.30, the full committee will be meeting in house room C.

[01:21:49] And then once HHS is finished, the full committee, then one of their other subcommittees, the health professions subcommittee will meet immediately upon adjournment of the full committee those three will all be stacked in house room c committee on transportation we're meeting at 9 a.m on the second floor in house committee room b uh and the two caucuses democrats uh and the republicans uh will be meeting at 11 30 tomorrow so we'll update that accordingly both of them will be meeting at 11 30 democrats in house room one republicans in house room two this and all of All the other announcements, in case you are asleep, are listed online in the House committee room schedule.

[01:22:26] That's all the announcements I have, sir. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. On the announcements just made by the clerk to expedite the flow of everyone's business, Finance Committee full will meet immediately after.

[01:22:44] It won't be that long. 15 minutes after that, it will be the meeting on civil sub will meet. Excuse me. Half hour after finance adjourns, then the criminal law subcommittee will meet.

[01:23:05] This is to expedite members. We will probably do this routinely. Any members on criminal sub who may have a bill before civil sub. So, again, House finance won't last that long, so please pay attention to the flow of business.

[01:23:22] Thank you. Sounds like Lego. Anyway, the delegate from Alexandria, delegate hearing. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. The delegate from Alexandria, delegate hearing, moves that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon.

[01:23:38] As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the delegate from Alexandria, delegate hearing. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. from alexander hearing moves at the house to now adjourn only got 30 seconds when the house adjourns then you can start gathering your things and moving your way not until the house adjourns that's many faith the motion will say aye those opposed no the motion is agreed to the house turns adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon



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